Project Overview

Conclusion

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By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department.

The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

2. Summary of Work Completed

The project was delivered in three milestones, each building on the one before it:

Milestone	Work completed	Result
1. Flow	Created the Standard Laptop task flow with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action that sets the short description, description, assignment group and approval.	An active flow ready to run.
2. Flow assignment	Attached the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item through the Process Engine tab.	The flow runs whenever the item is ordered.
3. Service Catalog	Placed an order, approved the request and opened the generated Catalog Task.	A Catalog Task assigned to the Hardware group, created automatically.

3. Problem Addressed

Before automation, the configuration task for an approved standard laptop had to be created and assigned manually, which led to delays, oversights and uneven workload for the hardware team. The flow removes this gap by creating the task automatically as soon as the request is approved and routing it straight to the Hardware group.

4. Objectives Achieved

Objective	How it was met
Seamless experience for users	The configuration task exists as soon as the request is approved, so configuration can start without waiting for manual follow-up.

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Reduced manual intervention and errors	The Catalog Task is created and populated by the flow with the same values every time.
Better resource utilisation	The task is assigned directly to the Hardware group, freeing procurement staff from follow-up work.
Higher efficiency and productivity	The flow runs automatically for every Standard Laptop order, giving a consistent and repeatable process.

5. Key Outcomes

- The **Standard Laptop task** flow is created and active in Flow Designer.
- The flow is attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item.
- Approving a Standard Laptop request generates a Catalog Task without manual action.
- The Catalog Task carries the short description *Laptop needs to Configured* and is assigned to the Hardware group.
- The Catalog Task is visible under the Catalog Tasks tab of the Requested Item, so progress is easy to follow.

6. Benefits Realised

Stakeholder	Benefit
End users	Shorter wait for a configured laptop and a more consistent experience.
IT procurement team	No manual creation or assignment of configuration tasks.
Hardware team	Receives clearly described tasks assigned directly to the team.
Organisation	A more efficient and reliable IT procurement process.

7. Key Learnings

- Flow Designer allows a routine process to be automated with a trigger and an action, without custom scripting.
- A flow only takes effect for a catalog item once it is attached through the Process Engine tab.
- Setting the short description and assignment group inside the flow keeps every task consistent.
- Testing with a real order and approval is the best way to confirm the automation works end to end.

8. Future Enhancements

- Send email notifications to the Hardware team and the requester when the task is created.

- Add SLA tracking to measure the time taken to configure laptops.
- Extend the same approach to other standard hardware and software catalog items.
- Add reporting on task volumes and completion times for the Hardware team.

9. Final Remarks

The project shows how a small, well-defined automation can remove a recurring source of delay in IT procurement. With the flow in place, each approved Standard Laptop request moves to configuration automatically, giving users a faster experience and giving the IT department a more efficient way of working. The same approach can be applied to other requests in the Service Catalog as the process matures.